

SCRIPTURE UNION NORTHERN IRELAND
CAMPS & MISSIONS 2026

TEAM DEVOTIONS

**LIVE
IN THE** *light*

SCRIPTURE UNION NORTHERN IRELAND
JOHN 8:12



REFLECTION 1

GENESIS 1:1–5

OPENING QUESTION

WHAT IF GOD'S FIRST MOVE TODAY ISN'T FIXING THINGS, BUT ILLUMINATING THEM?

PAUSE

COME HONESTLY BEFORE GOD.
TAKE A BREATH AND REMEMBER: GOD IS ALREADY PRESENT
WITH ME IN THIS DAY.

REJOICE

"IN THE BEGINNING... GOD SAID, 'LET THERE BE LIGHT.'"
BEFORE STRUCTURE, BEFORE LIFE, BEFORE MOVEMENT—GOD
BRINGS LIGHT.
HIS FIRST RESPONSE TO CHAOS IS ILLUMINATION.

PONDER

THINK OF SWITCHING ON THE LIGHTS IN A ROOM AFTER A
BUSY EVENING OF YOUR PROGRAMME. SUDDENLY YOU SEE
WHAT THE AFTERMATH OF THE HOSPITALITY, GAMES &
ACTIVITIES. THERES WORK TO DO, BUT LIGHT MAKES THE
WORK POSSIBLE.

GOD'S LIGHT DOESN'T SHAME CHAOS; IT REVEALS IT SO THAT
LIFE CAN GROW. WHEN GOD SHINES LIGHT, HOPE BEGINS.

- WHERE DO I FEEL CHAOS OR UNCERTAINTY TODAY, AND HOW MIGHT GOD BE INVITING LIGHT INTO IT?
- HOW CAN I CREATE SPACE IN MY SESSION FOR GOD TO BRING CLARITY RATHER THAN RUSHING TO FILL IT?

ASK

LORD, BRING YOUR LIGHT INTO THE UNSEEN SPACES OF
TODAY—MY HEART, MY LEADERSHIP, AND THE LIVES OF THE
CHILDREN & YOUNG PEOPLE WE SERVE.

YIELD

I CHOOSE TO TRUST THAT YOU ARE ALREADY WORKING IN
THIS MINISTRY BEFORE I ARRIVE.

LORD, SHINE YOUR LIGHT IN OUR GATHERINGS TODAY. HELP
YOUNG PEOPLE FEEL SAFE, SEEN, AND WELCOMED. LET THIS
SPACE BE ONE WHERE TRUTH AND HOPE BEGIN TO GROW.

REFLECTION 2

EXODUS 13:21–22

OPENING QUESTION

AM I TRYING TO LEAD WITH A MAP GOD NEVER PROMISED TO GIVE?

PAUSE

SLOW YOUR THOUGHTS AND REMEMBER THAT GOD GOES AHEAD OF YOU.

REJOICE

“THE LORD WENT AHEAD OF THEM... IN A PILLAR OF FIRE.”
GOD DOESN'T SEND INSTRUCTIONS FROM A DISTANCE. HE WALKS WITH HIS PEOPLE.

PONDER

WALKING A DARK PATH WITH A TORCH ONLY SHOWS THE NEXT FEW STEPS—BUT THAT'S ENOUGH TO KEEP MOVING.

GOD OFTEN GIVES GUIDANCE IN THE MOMENT, NOT MONTHS IN ADVANCE. DEPENDENCE IS PART OF THE JOURNEY.

–IN WHAT WAY MIGHT JESUS' CALL TO LOVE GOD AND LOVE OUR NEIGHBOUR BE ENOUGH GUIDANCE TO KEEP WALKING?

–HOW CAN I HELP YOUNG PEOPLE RECOGNISE GOD'S GUIDANCE IN SMALL, DAILY WAYS?

ASK

LORD, GUIDE MY WORDS, REACTIONS, AND DECISIONS TODAY.

YIELD

I LET GO OF NEEDING TO CONTROL EVERY OUTCOME.

LORD, GUIDE OUR CONVERSATIONS TODAY. LEAD THE DISCUSSIONS, THE LAUGHTER, AND EVEN THE UNEXPECTED MOMENTS. HELP US FOLLOW YOUR LEAD WITH THOSE WE SHARE THE DAY WITH.

REFLECTION 3

1 SAMUEL 16

OPENING QUESTION

WHO MIGHT I BE OVERLOOKING THAT GOD DEEPLY VALUES?

PAUSE

INVITE GOD TO HELP YOU SEE PEOPLE THROUGH HIS EYES.

REJOICE

"THE LORD LOOKS AT THE HEART."

PONDER

GOD CHOOSES DAVID WHILE HE IS STILL HIDDEN IN THE FIELDS.

SOMETIMES THE QUIETEST CHILD OR YOUNG PERSON CAN BECOME THE MOST SPIRITUALLY OPEN OVER TIME. GOD IS OFTEN WORKING BENEATH THE SURFACE. GOD NOTICES THE SMALL MOMENTS OF FAITH, CURIOSITY, AND HONESTY THAT OTHERS MISS.

-WHO MIGHT I BE OVERLOOKING BECAUSE THEY DON'T STAND OUT?

-HOW CAN I AFFIRM WHAT GOD IS DOING IN THE HIDDEN HEARTS OF YOUNG PEOPLE?

ASK

GIVE ME SENSITIVITY TO THE HEARTS OF THE CHILDREN & YOUNG PEOPLE TODAY.

YIELD

I WILL SLOW DOWN ENOUGH TO NOTICE WHAT YOU ARE DOING.

LORD, HELP US SEE EVERY CHILD & YOUNG PERSON AS YOU SEE THEM. GIVE US PATIENCE AND WISDOM WITH THOSE WHO STRUGGLE, WITHDRAW, OR CHALLENGE US.

REFLECTION 4

ISAIAH 9:2

OPENING QUESTION

WHAT IF GOD'S LIGHT OFTEN ARRIVES QUIETLY IN THE MIDDLE OF DIFFICULT SEASONS?

PAUSE

ACKNOWLEDGE BOTH YOUR NEED AND GOD'S PRESENCE WITH YOU.

REJOICE

"THE PEOPLE WALKING IN DARKNESS HAVE SEEN A GREAT LIGHT."

PONDER

SOMETIMES WE MIGHT THINK FEEL THAT THERE HASN'T BEEN A BREAKTHROUGH MOMENT IN OUR WEEK—BUT FOR ONE CHILD OR YOUNG PERSON, SIMPLY BEING WELCOMED MAY BE THE FIRST GLIMPSE OF HOPE.

GOD'S LIGHT OFTEN ARRIVES THROUGH STEADY PRESENCE RATHER THAN DRAMATIC CHANGE.

- WHERE AM I CURRENTLY EXPERIENCING DISCOURAGEMENT?
- HOW CAN I BE A HOPEFUL PRESENCE FOR YOUNG PEOPLE TODAY?

ASK

LORD, HELP ME CARRY HOPE INTO THE SPACES WHERE YOUNG PEOPLE FEEL LOST OR DISCOURAGED.

YIELD

I WILL TRUST THAT YOUR LIGHT WORKS EVEN WHEN I CANNOT SEE THE RESULTS.

LORD, SOME OF THE YOUNG PEOPLE WE MEET TODAY MAY BE CARRYING HEAVY THINGS. LET OUR TIME TOGETHER BE A PLACE WHERE YOUR LIGHT BEGINS TO BREAK THROUGH THEIR DARKNESS.

REFLECTION 5

JOHN 8:12

OPENING QUESTION

IS JESUS CLEARLY THE CENTRE OF WHAT WE ARE DOING TODAY?

PAUSE

FOCUS YOUR ATTENTION ON CHRIST.

REJOICE

"I AM THE LIGHT OF THE WORLD."

JESUS IS NOT SIMPLY A TEACHER POINTING TO TRUTH—HE IS THE SOURCE OF LIFE AND LIGHT ITSELF.

PONDER

A TORCH HELPS YOU SEE A LITTLE, BUT STEPPING INTO SUNLIGHT CHANGES EVERYTHING. JESUS IS LIKE THAT SUNLIGHT.

MINISTRY IS HEALTHIEST WHEN JESUS REMAINS AT THE CENTRE, RATHER THAN OUR ACTIVITIES OR PERSONALITIES.

- IN WHAT WAYS COULD JESUS BECOME MORE CENTRAL IN TODAY'S TIME WITH CHILDREN & YOUNG PEOPLE?
- HOW CAN I DECLARE AND DISPLAY JESUS NATURALLY AND AUTHENTICALLY?

ASK

HELP ME POINT OTHERS TO YOU TODAY.

YIELD

I RELEASE THE NEED TO IMPRESS OR CONTROL.

JESUS, HELP THOSE WE MEET ENCOUNTER SOMETHING REAL ABOUT YOU TODAY—THROUGH CONVERSATION, PRAYER, OR SIMPLE MOMENTS TOGETHER.

REFLECTION 6

MATTHEW 5:14–16

OPENING QUESTION

HOW MIGHT MY EVERYDAY ATTITUDE SHAPE THE SPIRITUAL ATMOSPHERE TODAY?

PAUSE

REMEMBER THAT GOD'S LIGHT SHINES THROUGH ORDINARY PEOPLE.

REJOICE

"YOU ARE THE LIGHT OF THE WORLD."

PONDER

A LEADER WHO REMEMBERS NAMES, LISTENS CAREFULLY, AND SHOWS KINDNESS, CAN OFTEN SHINE MORE LIGHT THAN ANY WELL-PREPARED TALK.

LIGHT DOESN'T STRIVE—IT SIMPLY SHINES.

- WHAT SMALL ACT OF KINDNESS OR ENCOURAGEMENT COULD I OFFER TODAY?
- HOW MIGHT MY ATTITUDE BEHIND THE SCENES INFLUENCE THE WHOLE GROUP?

ASK

HELP MY ACTIONS REFLECT YOUR CHARACTER TODAY.

YIELD

I OFFER YOU THE SMALL MOMENTS OF LEADERSHIP.

LORD, HELP OUR TEAM REFLECT YOUR LOVE THROUGH SIMPLE KINDNESS, PATIENCE, AND JOY TODAY.

REFLECTION 7

ACTS 2

OPENING QUESTION

AM I RELYING ON MY ENERGY, OR GOD'S SPIRIT?

PAUSE

OPEN YOURSELF TO THE HOLY SPIRIT.

REJOICE

"THEY WERE ALL FILLED WITH THE HOLY SPIRIT."

PONDER

LIKE TRYING TO RUN A PHONE ON LOW BATTERY—
MINISTRY BECOMES EXHAUSTING WITHOUT BEING
CONNECTED TO GOD'S POWER.

THE SPIRIT EMPOWERS ORDINARY PEOPLE TO DO
EXTRAORDINARY THINGS.

- WHERE DO I NEED THE SPIRIT'S RENEWAL TODAY?
- HOW CAN I REMAIN ATTENTIVE TO HIS
PROMPTING?

ASK

FILL ME AGAIN TODAY. USE ME. SHAPE ME.

YIELD

I TRUST THE SPIRIT TO WORK IN WAYS I CANNOT
PREDICT.

HOLY SPIRIT, GUIDE OUR DISCUSSIONS AND
RELATIONSHIPS TODAY. HELP THE CHILDREN &
YOUNG PEOPLE SENSE YOUR PRESENCE AND
RESPOND TO YOU.

REFLECTION 8

PSALM 119:105

OPENING QUESTION

WHAT NEXT STEP MIGHT GOD BE INVITING ME TO TAKE TODAY?

PAUSE

LISTEN FOR GOD'S VOICE THROUGH HIS WORD.

REJOICE

"YOUR WORD IS A LAMP FOR MY FEET."

PONDER

ON A LONG PATH, A SMALL WAYMARKER APPEARS JUST WHEN YOU NEED IT—NOT TO MAP THE WHOLE JOURNEY, BUT TO WHISPER, "KEEP GOING... YOU'RE STILL ON THE RIGHT TRACK."

WE READ SCRIPTURE FOR FORMATION, NOT JUST INFORMATION.

- WHAT SMALL STEP OF OBEDIENCE MIGHT GOD BE PROMPTING TODAY?
- HOW CAN I HELP CHILDREN & YOUNG PEOPLE ENGAGE MEANINGFULLY WITH THE BIBLE?

ASK

SPEAK THROUGH SCRIPTURE TODAY.

YIELD

I COMMIT TO SIMPLE OBEDIENCE.

LORD, LET YOUR WORD COME ALIVE FOR THE CHILDREN & YOUNG PEOPLE TODAY. HELP THEM SEE THAT SCRIPTURE SPEAKS INTO THEIR REAL LIVES.

REFLECTION 9

ACTS 9

OPENING QUESTION

COULD THE UNEXPECTED MOMENTS TODAY BE GOD'S INVITATIONS?

PAUSE

HOLD YOUR PLANS LOOSELY BEFORE GOD.

REJOICE

"A LIGHT FROM HEAVEN FLASHED AROUND HIM."

PONDER

SOMETIMES THE BEST MOMENTS WITH CHILDREN AND YOUNG PEOPLE HAPPEN WHEN THE PLAN CHANGES AND AN HONEST CONVERSATION BEGINS.

GOD OFTEN WORKS THROUGH INTERRUPTIONS RATHER THAN PERFECTLY STRUCTURED MOMENTS.

- AM I OPEN TO GOD WORKING OUTSIDE THE PROGRAMME PLAN TODAY?
- HOW CAN I CREATE SPACE FOR YOUNG PEOPLE TO RESPOND TO GOD?

ASK

HELP ME STAY OPEN TO YOUR TRANSFORMING WORK.

YIELD

I WELCOME YOUR CHANGES TO MY PLANS.

LORD, IF YOU WANT TO INTERRUPT OUR PLANS TODAY, WE WELCOME IT. LEAD US INTO THE CONVERSATIONS AND MOMENTS THAT TRULY MATTER.

REFLECTION 10

ACTS 9

OPENING QUESTION

WHAT IF NOTHING DONE IN GOD'S LIGHT IS EVER WASTED?

PAUSE

I LIFT MY EYES BEYOND TODAY'S ACTIVITIES.

REJOICE

"THE GLORY OF GOD GIVES IT LIGHT."

PONDER

A SHORT CONVERSATION WITH A CHILD OR YOUNG PERSON MAY SEEM SMALL NOW—BUT YEARS LATER IT MIGHT BE REMEMBERED AS THE MOMENT SOMETHING SHIFTED.

CHILDREN AND YOUTH MINISTRY IS OFTEN PLANTING SEEDS WHOSE GROWTH WE MAY NEVER SEE.

- HOW DOES ETERNITY RESHAPE HOW I SEE TODAY'S WORK?
- WHAT DOES FAITHFUL MINISTRY LOOK LIKE WHEN RESULTS ARE NOT IMMEDIATE?

ASK

GIVE ME FAITHFULNESS FOR THE LONG HAUL.

YIELD

I TRUST THAT YOU ARE WORKING BEYOND WHAT I CAN MEASURE.

LORD, TAKE THE THINGS WE HAVE DONE ON THIS CAMP OR MISSION, AND USE THEM IN WAYS FAR BEYOND WHAT WE CAN SEE. LET SEEDS OF FAITH TAKE ROOT IN THESE YOUNG LIVES.

LIVE IN THE *light*

SCRIPTURE UNION NORTHERN IRELAND
JOHN 8:12



RESOURCE CREATED BY REV. PAUL GALLUCCI
© THE BIG HOUSE IRELAND 2026. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED.